

GEOGRAPHY

INTRODUCTION

Geography is about determining the significance of “place” as it relates to the natural environment, the human environment, and interactions within and between them. To investigate geographic issues, students must analyse the influences and interrelationships that give a place its distinctive characteristics and thus its spatial importance. Geographic analysis also requires an investigation of the economic, environmental, social, and political perspectives that relate to an issue. The application of the concepts of geographic thinking, spatial skills, and the use of field studies are central to the geographic inquiry process and the learning of geography.

Strands

The Grade 11 and 12 geography courses each have five strands. In all of these courses, strand A, Geographic Inquiry and Skill Development, is followed by four content strands, which are organized thematically.

Citizenship Education

The expectations in the Grade 11 and 12 geography courses provide opportunities for students to explore a number of concepts connected to the citizenship education framework (see page 13).

The Concepts of Geographic Thinking

The four concepts of geographic thinking – spatial significance, patterns and trends, interrelationships, and geographic perspective – underpin thinking and learning in all geography courses in the Canadian and world studies program. At least one concept of geographic thinking is identified as the focus for each overall expectation in the content strands of these courses. The following chart describes each concept and provides sample questions related to it. These questions highlight opportunities for students to apply a specific concept in their studies. (See page 16 for a fuller discussion of the concepts of disciplinary thinking.)

Spatial Significance
This concept requires students to determine the importance of a place or region. They explore the connections that exist between the geographical location and physical characteristics of a site and analyse the unique relationships that exist in and between the natural and human environments in a particular place. Students come to understand that the significance of the same place may be different for humans, animals, and plants. Related Questions* – What does a population settlement map tell us about the preferred range of latitude for settlement in Canada? (CGC1P, B2.2) – How does the official plan for your community address urban sprawl? (CGC1D, E2.3) – How might the uniqueness of a destination make it more appealing to some and less appealing to others? (CGG3O, B1.2) – How does the location of a site influence the feasibility of different types of power generation there? (CGR4E, E3.4) – What are some of the challenges that communities in permafrost regions face in providing safe drinking water and disposing of waste? (CGR4M, E2.3)
Patterns and Trends
This concept requires students to recognize characteristics that are similar and that repeat themselves in a natural or human environment (patterns) and characteristics or traits that exhibit a consistent tendency in a particular setting over a period of time (trends). The characteristics may be spatial, social, economic, physical, or environmental. Students analyse connections between characteristics to determine patterns; they analyse connections between those characteristics over time to determine trends. Related Questions – What trends do you see in the use of alternative energy in Ontario? (CGC1P, A1.5) – What pattern or patterns do you see in the location of First Nations reserves across Canada? (CGC1D, D3.1) – What factors have led to population movement in the region? What specific locations have attracted migrants? Why? (CGD3M, E2.1) – In what ways has technological change amplified the impact of population growth on the natural environment? In what ways has it diminished it? (CGW4U, C2.2)

* These questions are drawn directly from the overview charts that precede the geography courses and from the sample questions that accompany many specific expectations. To highlight the continuity between the geography courses in Grade 11 and 12 and those in Grade 9, and to show possible development in the use of the concepts of geographic thinking over those grades, the chart includes some questions from the Grade 9 geography curriculum as well.

Interrelationships

This concept requires students to explore connections within and between natural and human environments. The interconnected parts of an environment or environments work together to form a system. Students must understand the relationships that exist within a system and then critically analyse the relationships between systems in order to determine the impact they have on one another.

Related Questions

- How does surrounding farmland support a community, and what stresses might the community place on the farmland? (CGC1P, E2.1)
- How might the breaking up of continental ice in Greenland and the Antarctic affect Canada's coastline? (CGC1D, B2.1)
- Why do we need to understand the earth's physical processes in order to predict their potential hazards? (CGF3M, Overview)
- How can international trade policies and corporate actions influence disparities within or between ecumenes? (CGU4M, D1.2)

Geographic Perspective

This concept requires students to consider the environmental, economic, political, and/or social implications of the issues, events, developments, and/or phenomena that they are analysing. In order to solve problems, make decisions or judgements, or formulate plans of action effectively, students need to develop their ability to examine issues from multiple perspectives.

Related Questions

- In what ways can cultural diversity enrich the life of a community? (CGC1P, D1.2)
- Does the financial benefit of extracting natural resources justify related social and/or environmental impacts? (CGC1D, A1.6)
- How might spatial technologies help governments assess the economic, environmental, infrastructural, and social risks of a potential disaster? Why is it important for governments to know and understand these risks? (CGT3O, D1.2)
- Why might some people believe that there is an ethical imperative to share the world's resources equitably? (CGW4C, Overview)
- Why might military and/or government satellite information be shared with or withheld from certain countries or military alliances? What are the implications of doing so? (CGO4M, D2.1)

The Geographic Inquiry Process

In each of the geography courses in the Canadian and world studies curriculum, strand A focuses explicitly on the geographic inquiry process, guiding students in their investigations of issues, events, developments, and/or various geographic phenomena. This process is *not* intended to be applied in a linear manner: students will use the applicable components of the process in the order most appropriate for them and for the task at hand. Although strand A covers all of the components of the inquiry process, it is important to note that students apply skills associated with the inquiry process throughout the content strands in each course. (See page 32 for a fuller discussion of the inquiry process in the Canadian and world studies program.)

The following chart identifies ways in which students may approach each of the components of the geographic inquiry process.

Formulate Questions
Students formulate questions: – to explore various events, developments, issues, and/or phenomena that are related to the overall expectations in order to identify the focus of their inquiry – to help them determine which key concept or concepts of geographic thinking are relevant to their inquiry – that reflect the selected concept(s) of geographic thinking – to develop criteria that they will use in evaluating data, evidence, and/or information; in making judgements, decisions, or predictions; in reaching conclusions; and/or in solving problems
Gather and Organize
Students: – collect relevant qualitative and quantitative data, evidence, and information from field studies^a and a variety of primary and secondary sources,^b including visuals^c and community resources^d – determine if their sources are credible, accurate, and reliable – identify the purpose and intent of each source – identify the points of view in the sources they have gathered – use a variety of methods to organize the data, evidence, and/or information they have gathered – record the sources of the data, evidence, and information they are using – decide whether they have collected enough data, evidence, and/or information for their inquiry

a. Field studies may include, but are not limited to, studies in local neighbourhoods, school grounds, and various sites that allow students to explore different land uses (e.g., recreational, commercial, industrial, and transportation uses).

b. Primary sources may include, but are not limited to, census data, land claims, letters, photographs, speeches, and works of art. Secondary sources may include, but are not limited to, documentaries and other films, news articles, reference books, and most websites.

c. Visuals may include, but are not limited to, satellite images, maps, globes, models, graphs, and diagrams.

d. Community resources may include, but are not limited to, local conservation areas, resources from community groups and associations, government resources, and local plans.

Interpret and Analyse
Students: – analyse data, evidence, and information, applying the relevant concepts of geographic thinking (see preceding chart) – use different types of graphic organizers to help them interpret and/or analyse their data, evidence, and information – identify the key points or ideas in each source – analyse graphs, charts, diagrams, and maps – construct graphs, charts, diagrams, and maps to help them analyse the issue, event, development, or phenomenon they are investigating – analyse their sources to determine the importance of an issue, event, development, or phenomenon for individuals or groups – identify biases in individual sources – determine if all points of view are represented in the source materials as a whole, and which, if any, are missing
Evaluate and Draw Conclusions
Students: – synthesize data, evidence, and information, and make informed, critical judgements based on that data, evidence, and information – determine the short- and long-term impact of an event, development, issue, or phenomenon on people and/or places – reach conclusions about the subject of their inquiry, and support them with their data, evidence, and information – make predictions based on their data, evidence, and information – determine the ethical implications of an issue or action – determine the action required, where appropriate
Communicate
Students: – use appropriate forms (e.g., oral, visual, written, multimedia) for different audiences and purposes – communicate their arguments, conclusions, predictions, and plans of action clearly and logically – use geographical terminology and concepts correctly and effectively – cite sources, using appropriate forms of documentation

Regional Geography, Grade 11

University/College Preparation

CGD3M

This course explores interrelationships between the land and people in a selected region as well as interconnections between this region and the rest of the world. Students will explore the region's environmental, socio-economic, and cultural characteristics and will investigate issues related to natural resources, economic development and sustainability, population change, globalization, and quality of life. Students will apply the concepts of geographic thinking and the geographic inquiry process, including spatial technologies, to investigate a range of geographic issues in the region.

Note: This course is developed and delivered with a focus, to be determined by the school, on the geography of a selected region of the world.

Prerequisite: Issues in Canadian Geography, Grade 9, Academic or Applied

OVERVIEW

The course has five strands. Instruction and learning related to the expectations in strand A are to be interwoven with instruction and learning related to expectations from the other four strands. Strand A must not be seen as independent of the other strands. Student achievement of the expectations in strand A is to be assessed and evaluated *throughout* the course.

Strand A

A. Geographic Inquiry and Skill Development
Overall Expectations
A1. Geographic Inquiry: use the geographic inquiry process and the concepts of geographic thinking when investigating geographic issues in a selected region
A2. Developing Transferable Skills: apply in everyday contexts skills, including spatial skills, developed through geographical investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in geography might be an asset

(continued)

Overview *(continued)*

Throughout this course, when planning instruction, teachers should weave the expectations from strand A in with the expectations from strands B–E.

Strands B–E

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Geographic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
B. Natural and Human Systems		
B1. Regional Characteristics: demonstrate an understanding of key cultural and socio-economic characteristics of the selected region and of individual countries in it (FOCUS ON: <i>Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Regions are not culturally or economically homogeneous.	Why might there be variation in the economies of different countries within a region? What factors account for these differences?
B2. Patterns of Natural and Human Systems: describe patterns in natural features and population distribution in the selected region, and analyse the relationship between them (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Interrelationships</i>)	Human settlement patterns are affected by, and also affect, the natural environment.	In what ways can the environment affect human settlement? In what ways can human settlement affect the environment?
B3. Quality of Life: assess quality of life in the selected region, including factors that contribute to quality of life and policies/programs that aim to improve it (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Quality of life in a region is influenced by many factors.	Why might this environmental impact have social, political, or economic consequences? What considerations might be missing from some of the common indicators used to measure quality of life?
C. Sustainability and Stewardship		
C1. Sustainability and Stewardship of Natural Resources: analyse issues associated with sustainability and stewardship of natural resources in the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective</i>)	The sustainability of natural resources within regions is affected by social, political, economic, and environmental factors.	Why might some countries be better able than others to extract and use natural resources in a sustainable way?
C2. Inequality and Sustainability: analyse aspects of inequality and economic sustainability in the selected region, including programs intended to promote equality and sustainability (FOCUS ON: <i>Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships</i>)	All regions experience issues related to economic sustainability and equality.	Why is it important to look at current economic data as well as historical information when investigating regional inequalities?
C3. Development Projects/Megaprojects: analyse various issues associated with development projects, including, where applicable, megaprojects, in the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Large-scale development projects can lead to local and regional social, political, economic, and/or environmental issues.	How might competing interests and ideas affect large development and/or construction projects? What strategies can be used to mitigate possible conflicts among stakeholders?

* See page 17 for a discussion of the purpose of big ideas and framing questions.

Overall Expectations and Related Concepts of Geographic Thinking	Big Ideas*	Framing Questions*
D. Regional and International Interactions		
D1. International Organizations in the Region: analyse the role and involvement of intergovernmental organizations in the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Intergovernmental organizations often help address regional issues.	What key geopolitical issues in this region are of global concern? Why?
D2. Conflict and Cooperation: analyse aspects of economic, social, and political conflict and cooperation in the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	The interrelationship among different peoples and between countries within a region is constantly changing.	Why is it important to consider the history of a region when studying the present-day relationship among its peoples and/or between its countries?
D3. Economic Development: analyse economic activity in the selected region as well as factors that contribute to the region's economic development (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Interrelationships</i>)	Many current and historical factors affect the economies of countries within a region.	Has war had an impact on the economies of the region? In what ways are regional economies tied to international issues and other countries' economies?
E. Dynamics and Change		
E1. Globalization: analyse how globalization has affected the selected region and how the region has responded to it (FOCUS ON: <i>Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective</i>)	Issues related to globalization can have social, economic, political, and environmental implications.	In what ways has globalization had an impact on the lives of people and the environment in this region? Has globalization benefited all countries in this region?
E2. Shifting Populations: analyse current as well as historical patterns of population movement and distribution in the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends</i>)	Demographic trends can affect a region and the issues that concern it.	How are global population trends reflected in this region?
E3. Climate Change and Natural Hazards: explain how climate, including climate change, and natural hazards affect the selected region (FOCUS ON: <i>Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships</i>)	Natural processes and climate change can cause social, economic, political, and environmental problems in a region.	How is climate change affecting this region? How might it affect it in the future? Which natural hazards are most likely to have an impact on this region? Do all countries within this region face the same threats?

A. GEOGRAPHIC INQUIRY AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Geographic Inquiry:** use the geographic inquiry process and the concepts of geographic thinking when investigating geographic issues in a selected region;
- A2. Developing Transferable Skills:** apply in everyday contexts skills, including spatial skills, developed through geographical investigation, and identify some careers in which a background in geography might be an asset.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Geographic Inquiry

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** formulate different types of questions to guide investigations into geographic issues in the selected region (e.g., factual questions: *Which country in the region has the highest income per capita?*; comparative questions: *Which government strategy is more apt to improve the lives of children in a country, an increase in funding for education or for food and water safety?*; causal questions: *How have population shifts had an impact on the region?*)

- A1.2** select and organize relevant data and information on geographic issues in the selected region from a variety of primary and secondary sources (e.g., primary: *photographs; raw data, both quantitative and qualitative; satellite images; statistics*; secondary: *atlases, books, charts, digital and print maps, graphs, magazines, newspapers, websites*), ensuring that their sources represent a range of perspectives

Sample questions: “How might you use employment, income, and industry statistics to analyse economic development patterns in different parts of the region? Where might you find this data and information?” “What type of data and information do you need to collect in order to assess the rate of extraction of a specific resource and the impact on the local people?” “What types of maps and graphs will help you analyse the impact of a megaproject in the region?”

- A1.3** assess the credibility of sources and information relevant to their investigations (e.g., by

considering how the data are constructed to support the author’s point of view, the possible bias of the author, the expertise of the author, the accuracy of the text and supporting data, the intended audience, the purpose of the messaging, the context in which the information was presented)

Sample questions: “Whose point of view does this source represent? Is the source biased? Have you consulted other sources that represent other points of view? Which source is most credible and why?” “Are the authors’ conclusions consistent with the data they cite?”

- A1.4** interpret and analyse data and information relevant to their investigations, using various tools, strategies, and approaches appropriate for geographic inquiry (e.g., *interpret diagrams illustrating the flow of money into and out of the region; analyse graphs and charts showing data related to quality of life indicators for countries in the region to determine trends and correlations; use decision-making templates to help them analyse different points of view on an issue of concern to the region; outline various perspectives on the impact of foreign investment in the region*)

Sample questions: “What type of graphic organizer might help you analyse the impact of multinational corporations on the region?” “What data layers and types of information might you include when using a geographic information system (GIS) to analyse the relationship between physical features and natural resources in the region?”

- A1.5** use the concepts of geographic thinking (i.e., spatial significance, patterns and trends, interrelationships, geographic perspective) when

analysing and evaluating data and information, formulating conclusions, and making judgements about geographic issues in the selected region (e.g., *use the concept of spatial significance to explain natural hazards to which the region is prone; use the concept of patterns and trends to analyse short- and long-term population trends and phenomena such as the shift of population to urban centres; use the concept of interrelationships to analyse the impact that economic development has had on indigenous peoples in the region; use the concept of geographic perspective to analyse the social, political, economic, and environmental impact of globalization on the region*)

Sample questions: “Why would it be useful to apply the concept of spatial significance when investigating the characteristics of a region?” “How might an understanding of patterns and trends guide your analysis of the effectiveness of international aid in improving maternal health in the region?” “How might an understanding of interrelationships guide your examination of the connections between the distribution of natural resources and their development in the region?” “How might applying the concept of geographic perspective help you understand the advantages and disadvantages of tourism in the region?”

- A1.6** evaluate and synthesize their findings to formulate conclusions and/or make informed judgements or predictions about the issues they are investigating

Sample questions: “What did you find out about how foreign ownership affects economic disparity in various countries in the selected regions? What conclusions can you draw about why foreign ownership may have different effects in different countries?”

- A1.7** communicate their ideas, arguments, and conclusions using various formats and styles, as appropriate for the audience and purpose (e.g., *a presentation for classmates on trade between Canada and the selected region; a debate on the pros and cons of resource and/or industrial development in the region; a webcast or podcast for the general public on how issues related to food security affect the region; a photo essay for a local community group to illustrate various ways in which the community is connected to other regions of the world*)

Sample questions: “What kind of information does your audience need? How much detail would be appropriate? What format and approach would be most effective in conveying your information to this particular audience?”

- A1.8** use accepted forms of documentation (e.g., *footnotes, author/date citations, reference lists, bibliographies, credits*) to reference different types of sources (e.g., *articles, oral recounts, blogs, books, databases, films, websites*)

- A1.9** use appropriate terminology when communicating the results of their investigations (e.g., *vocabulary specific to their inquiry; terminology related to geography and to the concepts of geographic thinking*)

A2. Developing Transferable Skills

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** describe ways in which geographic investigation can help them develop skills, including spatial skills and the essential skills in the Ontario Skills Passport (e.g., *skills related to reading graphic texts, writing, graphing, computer use, use of GIS and/or satellite imagery, oral communication, numeracy, decision making, planning, management, finding information, problem solving*), that can be transferred to postsecondary opportunities, the world of work, and everyday life

- A2.2** apply in everyday contexts skills and work habits developed through geographic investigation (e.g., *use critical thinking, mapping, and/or graphing skills to help them analyse an issue of local importance; use listening skills in discussions to help them understand multiple perspectives; apply work habits such as collaboration when sharing ideas and information with a team, or self-regulation to identify strategies for achieving a goal*)

- A2.3** apply the concepts of geographic thinking when analysing current events involving geographic issues (e.g., *use the concept of spatial significance to analyse the importance of pollinators to agricultural production and the impact of their decline; use the concept of patterns and trends to enhance their understanding of issues related to global population shifts; use the concept of interrelationships to help them understand a current issue related to gender inequality; use the concept of geographic perspective to analyse the impact of climate change*) in order to enhance their understanding of these issues and their role as informed citizens

- A2.4** identify some careers in which a geography background might be an asset (e.g., *economic development officer, GIS technician, international aid worker, marketing analyst, owner of an importing business, travel industry analyst, travel writer, urban planner, environmental scientist*)

B. NATURAL AND HUMAN SYSTEMS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Regional Characteristics:** demonstrate an understanding of key cultural and socio-economic characteristics of the selected region and of individual countries in it (**FOCUS ON:** *Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective*)
- B2. Patterns of Natural and Human Systems:** describe patterns in natural features and population distribution in the selected region, and analyse the relationship between them (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Interrelationships*)
- B3. Quality of Life:** assess quality of life in the selected region, including factors that contribute to quality of life and policies/programs that aim to improve it (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Regional Characteristics

FOCUS ON: *Patterns and Trends; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify the countries in the region and analyse information and data to determine basic differences between them (*e.g., use maps to compare population density, locate and analyse statistics to compare ethnic and/or religious make-up, interpret and analyse visual images to compare topography*)

Sample questions: “What types of visual sources might you use when investigating similarities and differences in the physical geography of different countries in this region? How might you communicate your findings using a map?” “Where might you find information on the different political systems in the countries in this region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can explore satellite images to gain an understanding of the different types of information that can be gathered by satellite. Satellite imagery can also help students develop a sense of spatial orientation for the region.

- B1.2** describe the region’s main cultures (*e.g., with reference to language; religious groups; ethnic groups, including indigenous cultures; the arts; food; history*), and assess the level of cultural diversity in the region

Sample questions: “What are some significant cultural differences between the countries of the region? How has the history of the region contributed to these differences?” “Would you characterize the region as culturally diverse or homogeneous?”

- B1.3** analyse data on various economic indicators to investigate where individual countries in the region, and the region as a whole, rank within the global economy (*e.g., with reference to natural resources, gross domestic product [GDP] and/or gross national product [GNP], value of exports, per capita income, debt, aid, types of industry, and/or infrastructure*)

Sample questions: “Where might you find data on the GDP of countries in this region? Are there significant variations in GDP among these countries? How does the region’s GDP compare to that of countries outside the region? What are the implications of these differences?” “Are there emerging economies in the region? If so, have they affected the trend in global rankings in recent years?”

Using spatial skills: Students can plot data on various economic measures onto graphs to show patterns in the region or between this region and other regions of the world. Graphs can be placed on a regional or world map to show the spatial distribution of these patterns.

B2. Patterns of Natural and Human Systems

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Interrelationships*

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 describe natural features of the region (e.g., *landforms, vegetation, climate, soils, water bodies, natural resources*), and analyse the relationship between them

Sample questions: “Which landforms dominate the region?” “What is the relationship between landforms, climate, and vegetation in the region?” “How are the landforms of the region related to its natural resources?” “What criteria would you use when rating the biodiversity of this region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can construct thematic maps showing landform and climate regions within the selected area. By adding an overlay map that uses symbols to indicate the location of different types of natural resources, students can explore the interrelationship between landforms, climate, and resources in the region.

B2.2 describe current patterns of population distribution in the region, with a particular focus on areas of high population density, and assess the impacts, both positive and negative, of these patterns (e.g., *preservation of natural ecosystems in some areas of low population; urban sprawl, gated communities, traffic congestion, slums, air pollution, waste management challenges, access to and/or pressure on services/infrastructure, a broader range of economic opportunities in areas of high population*)

Sample questions: “What proportion of the population in this region is urban? What proportion of people live in small towns/villages? Are these proportions similar for all countries in the region?” “What are the major cities in this region? What sorts of pressures do they face? What are some policies/strategies that governments and/or citizens’ groups have developed for dealing with these pressures? How effective are they?”

B2.3 analyse key relationships between natural features and population distribution in the region (e.g., *with reference to settlement near bodies of water; location of resource towns, tourist towns; agricultural settlements near volcanoes; sparse settlement in mountainous, desert, or ice-covered regions*)

Sample questions: “Which parts of the physical environment of this region have attracted people and sustained population growth? Why

have these areas been particularly conducive to population growth?” “What are some challenges that the natural features of this region have presented to settlement? What impact have these challenges had on population distribution in the region? Are there areas in this region where the environment has precluded settlement?”

B3. Quality of Life

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 analyse various criteria that are used to measure quality of life, and assess quality of life in the region with reference to several of these criteria (e.g., *literacy rates; access to education, medical care, clean water, sanitation, and adequate housing; GDP per capita; per capita income; life expectancy; infant and/or maternal mortality; gender inequality; unemployment and poverty rates; military spending; national debt*)

Sample questions: “Why is gender inequality used as a criterion in measuring quality of life? What are some indications of gender equality/inequality in this region?” “Are the statistics in relation to quality of life consistent across the region? If not, how might you account for differences?” “If data were not available, could you use photographs to help you get a sense of the quality of life of people in the region? Why or why not? Why do we have to examine our biases before making observations based on photographs?” “Do you think the region can sustain, or improve, the current quality of life for future generations? Why or why not?”

Using spatial skills: Students can support their analysis of the quality of life in a region by creating a series of graphs using data on indicators that are associated with quality of life (e.g., literacy rates, infant mortality). Students can select two quality of life indicators for countries in the region and plot the related data on a scatter graph to assess the correlation between these indicators.

B3.2 analyse how various factors affect quality of life indicators in the region (e.g., *public expenditures on education, health, infrastructure, social services; war; drought or other natural or human-made disasters; pandemics; government corruption; misappropriation of aid; labour and environmental standards/regulations; discrimination against women or minorities; inequitable access to resources; food security*)

Sample questions: “Where does this region rank in terms of public expenditures on education

and health care? What relationship do you see between this ranking and the region's ranking with regard to quality of life?" "What is the relationship between environmental stewardship and quality of life? How is that relationship evident in this region?" "Why do analysts speak of a 'cycle of poverty'? What factors contribute to the cycle? Why is it so difficult to break?"

B3.3 assess the effectiveness of programs, policies, and strategies of various groups and organizations, including governments, aimed at improving the quality of life for people in the region (*e.g., policies related to public education, food and water safety, income support for unemployed, aged, and/or disabled people; programs to improve literacy rates among women, reduce the spread of infectious diseases, improve maternal health, provide clean water; strategies such as the provision of microcredit*)

Sample questions: "What types of income-support policies exist in this region? How effective do you think they are at improving quality of life in this region?" "Why do some aid or social service programs specifically target women and children? Are there any such programs in this region? If so, how effective do you think they are?"

Using spatial skills: Students could use data from a number of years to create a set of population pyramids for countries or indigenous populations in the region and then analyse these graphs to determine the effectiveness of strategies for improving quality of life in the region.

C. SUSTAINABILITY AND STEWARDSHIP

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Sustainability and Stewardship of Natural Resources:** analyse issues associated with sustainability and stewardship of natural resources in the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective*)
- C2. Inequality and Sustainability:** analyse aspects of inequality and economic sustainability in the selected region, including programs intended to promote equality and sustainability (**FOCUS ON:** *Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships*)
- C3. Development Projects/Megaprojects:** analyse various issues associated with development projects, including, where applicable, megaprojects, in the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Sustainability and Stewardship of Natural Resources

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify the main natural resources that are harvested/extracted in the region (*e.g., water, wood, oil and/or gas, coal, minerals, fish, cotton, wheat, rice, livestock*), and assess the sustainability of current rates of harvesting/extraction

Sample questions: “What is the pattern of resource extraction in the region? What resources are harvested? Do they tend to be used in the region or exported? Is there pressure to increase rates of extraction?” “Does this region have enough fresh water to meet its current needs? Is the use of water for agriculture sustainable? Do you think water shortages will be an issue in this region in the future? Why or why not?” “What impact has the clearing of land for grazing had on local ecosystems?”

Using spatial skills: Students can create a variety of graphs (*e.g., line, bar, circle*) to illustrate patterns and trends relating to regional natural resource extraction.

- C1.2** assess the effects, both positive and negative, on the region of outside demand for its products and/or resources (*e.g., development of infrastructure, job creation, improvement in standards of*

living, increase in tax revenue, deforestation and other types of resource depletion/mismanagement, monoculture and other unsustainable agricultural practices, vulnerability to demands of multinational corporations, sweatshops, air pollution, environmental degradation)

Sample questions: “Which natural resources that are found in this region are in global demand? Has demand for these resources contributed to political or social conflict?” “Why might a government respond to demand for natural resources by either privatizing or nationalizing those resources? Have any countries in this region taken either action? If resources were privatized, who benefited from this move? Who did not?” “Is the issue of bulk water exports relevant to this region? If so, why might groups in the region have different perspectives on this issue?” “How have technological developments increased outside access to the region’s resources? What are the consequences of this increased access?”

Using spatial skills: Students can read/construct flow maps and various graphs to visualize/illustrate data on the types of commodities and products exported by the region and who imports them.

- C1.3** describe programs in the region that are intended to foster stewardship/sustainability with respect to natural resources (*e.g., programs related to resource conservation, alternative energy, tree planting, water quality, seed saving, sustainable*

agricultural practices, land rehabilitation, recycling and waste disposal), and assess their effectiveness

Sample questions: “Have businesses in this region implemented any programs that contribute to stewardship/sustainability? If so, what are they? How would you determine their effectiveness?” “Are there any fair-trade programs in the region? If so, what impact have they had on producers?” “What barriers exist to the development and implementation of stewardship programs?” “How might a family save money by participating in a stewardship or sustainability program?”

- C1.4** explain how imperialism/colonialism has affected the region, with reference to its people and their relationship with the natural resources in the region (e.g., with respect to the region’s status as a former colony or imperial power; the exploitation of people and natural resources before, during, and after the colonial period; the impact of colonization on indigenous peoples and/or the language, religion, and culture of the region; current cultural/economic imperialism)

Sample questions: “If this region was colonized, how did practices associated with imperial control affect the types of resources that were harvested or the way this was done? Did colonialism affect who controlled these resources? Is control of resources a continuing issue in this region? Were indigenous people in this region displaced as a result of colonization?” “If countries in this region were imperial powers, what was their relationship with indigenous people in their colonies? What were some of the key short- and long-term effects of this relationship for the indigenous people? Do these historical relationships continue to affect indigenous people today?”

C2. Inequality and Sustainability

FOCUS ON: *Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships*

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe the four economic sectors (i.e., primary, secondary, tertiary, and quaternary) and analyse data to assess differences between countries in this region with respect to employment and production in these sectors

Sample questions: “What types of jobs characterize the primary sector? Are any of the countries in this region highly dependent on this sector? If so, what do you think this means for the health of their economy?” “What factors

might account for the dominance of a different economic sector (or sectors) in different countries of the region?”

- C2.2** analyse aspects of inequality within the region (e.g., with reference to gender inequality; racial, ethnic, class, and/or religious discrimination; political disenfranchisement; economic inequality between countries in the region; class inequalities within countries), including key causes and consequences of disparities between different groups of people

Sample questions: “What are some measures of gender equality? How does this region rank with regard to these measures? What impact do levels of gender equality or inequality in the region have on women, families, and/or the economy?” “What is the level of income inequality in this region? What are the causes of such inequality?” “Does trade cause, contribute to, or help mitigate economic disparity in the region?” “Can the distribution of natural resources explain current economic disparity?” “What is the status of indigenous people in this region? Do they have rights to and control over their traditional lands? If not, where and under what conditions do they live?” “Has colonialism affected the social, economic, and/or political status of different groups in the region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can use graphs to help them analyse statistical data about the type and impact of inequality in the region.

- C2.3** assess the sustainability of the regional economy (e.g., the extent to which the economy depends on non-renewable resources; the mix of primary, secondary, and tertiary industries; whether taxes generate sufficient funds to finance public infrastructure and social programs; the number of stable, well-paid jobs; whether profits stay in the region or go to a multinational corporation headquartered elsewhere)

Sample questions: “How important is public spending, such as the financing of health care, education, and infrastructure, to the health and sustainability of an economy? In what ways is such spending also a measure of the health of the economy? What does public spending in this region tell you about the sustainability of the regional economy?” “What does the dominance of non-renewable resources in a country’s economy mean for the sustainability of the economy?”

Using spatial skills: Students can construct maps illustrating the location of various natural resources and using symbols to indicate whether a resource is renewable or non-renewable.

C2.4 describe the role of non-governmental organizations (NGOs), as well as international government aid, in the region (e.g., with reference to which countries in this region receive or contribute to foreign aid; the work of NGOs in areas such as environmental protection, economic development, human rights, alternative income programs), and evaluate their effectiveness in promoting sustainability

Sample questions: “Do countries in this region receive aid from governments and/or NGOs? If so, why? What are some issues that the support targets? What do they tell you about challenges facing this region?” “Which NGOs are most active in this region? Why? Who funds the NGO most active in this region? How might this funding affect attitudes towards this NGO?” “What criteria might you use when evaluating the success of an NGO in the region? What data would you need for such an evaluation?” “Do some countries within this region contribute to international aid? If so, in what form is aid given? Is the aid given to other countries within the region or to countries in other regions? How do the recipient countries use the aid? Is the aid effective in promoting sustainability within these countries?”

C3. Development Projects/ Megaprojects

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 analyse how development projects, particularly, where applicable, megaprojects, affect the sustainability of human and natural systems in the region (e.g., with reference to the development of dams and other hydroelectric projects, public transportation projects, energy pipelines, alternative energy projects, new factories, nuclear power plants, weapons systems, large-scale sports events)

Sample questions: “Who chooses which projects are developed in this region?” “Have countries in this region benefited from large-scale development projects? Did all people in these countries benefit? If not, who did not benefit? In what ways did the projects have a negative impact?” “What impact have some past development projects/megaprojects in this region had on the environment? Do you think they were worth the environmental cost? Why or why not?” “Are new transportation and/or other infrastructure megaprojects necessary for the economic development of this region? Why or why not?”

C3.2 compare the perspectives of different groups on development projects, including, where applicable, megaprojects, in the region

Sample questions: “Why might a government support a megaproject? Why might it refuse to support, or require modifications to, such a project? Even if it has the support of government, why might some other stakeholders oppose a large-scale development?” “Who has a stake in a current development project in the region? What are their points of view about it? How would you account for differences in perspectives? Which do you agree with? Why?” “Are there indigenous people in this region who have a stake in this project? If so, what is their perspective? Does it differ from that of the governments and/or the businesses/business sectors involved in the construction of the project? If so, how and why?”

C3.3 describe some alternatives to large-scale developments/megaprojects in the region, and explain their advantages and disadvantages (e.g., small-scale alternative energy programs, use of solar or geothermal energy in individual buildings, conservation programs)

Sample questions: “What are some alternative energy sources in this region? Are there programs that promote their development?” “What barriers or challenges exist to the development and implementation of alternative infrastructure projects?” “What are the main disadvantages of large-scale development projects? Why might these disadvantages lead some groups to advocate for smaller-scale projects? What sorts of challenges or disadvantages might be associated with these smaller projects?”

D. REGIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL INTERACTIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. International Organizations in the Region:** analyse the role and involvement of intergovernmental organizations in the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- D2. Conflict and Cooperation:** analyse aspects of economic, social, and political conflict and cooperation in the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- D3. Economic Development:** analyse economic activity in the selected region as well as factors that contribute to the region's economic development (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Interrelationships*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. International Organizations in the Region

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** analyse the role countries in the region play in intergovernmental organizations [IGOs] (e.g., *United Nations [UN], World Bank, World Health Organization, World Trade Organization, Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, Commonwealth, La Francophonie, African Union, European Union, Organization of American States, Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation*)

Sample questions: “Which countries in the region have made monetary contributions to IGOs?” “Why are countries in the region active in IGOs?” “Are there disagreements in the region regarding involvement in IGOs?” “What are the criteria used to determine membership in an IGO? Who is allowed to join or work with the IGOs within the region? Who isn’t? Why?”

- D1.2** assess the effectiveness of intergovernmental organizations and/or agreements in addressing issues in the region (e.g., *with reference to UN Women; UN conventions on climate change, children’s rights, and/or the rights of indigenous peoples; the International Criminal Court; alliances, treaties, and/or defence agreements; trade agreements*)

Sample questions: “What are some key geopolitical issues in this region that are of

international concern? Have IGOs responded to such issues? Why or why not?” “Do quality of life indicators in this region suggest the need for support from IGOs?” “What impact have international political agreements had on this region?” “Has a UN force or troops from a military alliance been sent to the region to try to keep the peace or resolve a conflict? What was the source of the conflict? How effective was the international force in defusing it?”

D2. Conflict and Cooperation

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** explain interrelationships between economic change/development and conflict and/or cooperation involving this region (e.g., *how economic development has heightened tensions over land claims or sovereignty; cooperation on and/or disagreement over joint megaprojects; disagreements over emissions targets or other environmental issues; local resistance to the practices of multinational corporations; conflict over the sale and/or privatization of water or the use of genetically modified organisms [GMOs] in the region’s agriculture industry*)

Sample questions: “Have economic developments in this region affected the ability of indigenous people to access or live off their traditional lands? If so, how did these people respond to the threat to their rights and/or way of life?” “What are some economic projects that

required cooperation between countries in the region or between this region and other countries? What type of negotiation was required for the success of the project? Who benefited from the project? Was there anyone who did not benefit from or who was adversely affected by the project?" "Why might a megaproject lead to conflict between countries in the region and/or outside of the region?" "Have foreign interests and/or multinational corporations contributed to a conflict related to regional economic development? If the conflict escalates, how might it affect people in the region?"

D2.2 analyse key aspects of trade in this region, including trade among countries within the region as well as with those elsewhere in the world (e.g., *trade agreements, trade wars, most important trading partners, largest imports and exports, whether the region exports raw materials or manufactured products, whether there is a trade surplus or deficit*), and assess the impact of trade in this region

Sample questions: "Does this region, or do countries within this region, have trade agreements with other countries? If so, what impact have such agreements had on the region? Do you think they have benefited the region economically? Have they had a cultural impact? Do most people in the region/country support the agreements? If not, who does not?" "What data would you need to gather in order to assess the success of a trade agreement in reducing economic disparities between partners?" "What import and export patterns can you identify in this region?" "Are there resources that the region must import from other regions? Why?" "Is there evidence of increased trade liberalization in countries in the selected region? Is the liberalization the result of national or regional initiatives?"

Using spatial skills: Students can construct proportional flow maps of imports and exports to help them visualize trade data and analyse the volume and direction of trade flows. Students can use graphs to depict the value of exports and imports and develop their understanding of trade balances.

D2.3 analyse key causes of social and/or cultural conflict and cooperation within the region (e.g., *conflict: historical exploitation by colonial powers; historical conflicts between communities based on race, class, ethnicity, language, culture, or religion; population pressures from refugees and/or from*

migrants moving from rural to urban environments; suppression of human rights; disagreements between religious groups over appropriate cultural expression; cooperation: regional development projects that are autonomous and self-sufficient; the need to organize to respond to issues of concern to indigenous peoples, women, environmentalists; responses to human or natural disasters; cultural events or exchanges)

Sample questions: "Where in the region is there evidence of conflict between different cultural groups? What are the roots of this conflict? Is this conflict within or between countries? What role, if any, does former colonial rule play in the present conflict?" "Has conflict arisen in this region as a result of attempts to undermine the cultural traditions of indigenous peoples?" "Are there migrant neighbourhoods in the region? What supports do they offer to migrants?" "Would you characterize countries in this region as multicultural, or are minority cultures expected to integrate into mainstream culture?" "Are there grassroots groups that have been created to address specific socio-cultural issues in the region? What issues are they responding to?"

D2.4 describe instances of political conflict or cooperation in the region, and explain their impact (e.g., *conflict: civil war or international conflict; coups d'états; protests related to political policy, government legitimacy, land claims; suppression of dissent by governments; invasion/aggression over disputed territory; economic or diplomatic sanctions; cooperation: pro-democracy movements; regional groups such as the African Union, Organization of American States, European Union; treaties/alliances*)

Sample questions: "What political disputes exist within the selected region? What historical factors have contributed to these disputes? What impact have these disputes had on people in the region?" "Have foreign powers, or agencies of foreign powers, become involved in conflicts in this region? Why or why not? What impact has their involvement, if any, had on the region?" "What evidence, if any, exists of increased political cooperation within and between countries in the region? Are there emerging regional political organizations in the selected region? If so, what are their goals?" "Are there national/ethnic or indigenous groups seeking independence or self-government in this region? What tactics have these groups used?"

D3. Economic Development

FOCUS ON: Spatial Significance; Interrelationships

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 analyse how various factors affect economic development in the region (*e.g., richness and accessibility of natural resources; level of infrastructure and technology; availability of an educated, skilled workforce; access to markets; subsidies or tariffs, whether within the region or among its trade partners; historical trade and development patterns; legacy of colonialism; political policies; political and social stability*)

Sample questions: “How great an impact has government policy had on the economic development of this region?” “What barriers to economic development exist in this region?” “If there are significant differences in the level of economic development among countries in this region, how would you account for these differences?”

D3.2 describe the main types of industry in the region (*e.g., manufacturing, agriculture and food processing, resource extraction and processing, tourism, service industries, energy generation, knowledge-based industries, high-tech industries*), and assess their impact

Sample questions: “Which type of industry employs the greatest number of people in the region? Who benefits most from the products of this industry?” “Which type of industry makes the greatest contribution to the GDP of countries in this region?” “How would you characterize agriculture in this region? Is it dominated by monoculture and multinational agribusiness corporations, or does it tend to be smaller in scale?” “Do manufacturing jobs in this region tend to be well-paid, unionized jobs, poorly paid jobs in sweatshops, or something in between?” “What impact does industry have on the environment in this region?” “How would you gather evidence on the positive and negative impacts of industrial activity on people in the region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can analyse statistics to predict the future of a natural resource-based industry in the region (*e.g., mining, water, agriculture, energy*) and can construct a line graph that shows change over time.

D3.3 explain the relationship between the distribution of natural resources in the region and their development (*e.g., the amount of a resource that is available and the ease with which it can be*

accessed, extracted, and transported; the relative remoteness or inaccessibility of the area in which resources are located; political disputes over land and/or ownership of resources; the environmental sensitivity of the land where the resources are)

Sample questions: “What natural resources in this region are economically viable? Are there resources in the region that have not been developed? If so, why? Are there resources in the region that can be sustainably managed? Is this being done?” “Who is responsible for funding infrastructure, such as roads, ports, and railways, that supports resource extraction?” “How does the natural environment, and its resources, affect the economic development of countries within the selected region?”

D3.4 explain the benefits and disadvantages of the operations of multinational corporations [MNCs] in the region (*e.g., with reference to creation of jobs, influence of MNCs on government policy, construction of infrastructure, resource depletion, violations of human rights, changes in labour and/or environmental standards, funds from corporate taxes*)

Sample questions: “Are there MNCs that are headquartered in this region? What are they and why are they located there? Are there MNCs that are headquartered elsewhere but have operations in this region? What is the difference between the two for the regional economy?” “How important are MNCs to the regional economy? Where might you find data on the proportion of the labour force that works for an MNC?” “Do MNCs regard environmental and labour regulations in this region as favourable? Why or why not?” “Have factories owned or supported by MNCs in this region been the source of environmental disasters or labour violations? Have such events led governments to tighten lax labour/environmental protection laws? If not, why not?”

D3.5 analyse the advantages and disadvantages of foreign investment for this region, with reference, as appropriate, to countries that invest and those that attract investment

Sample questions: “Is this region a net source of or destination for foreign investment?” “Are there aspects of the economy of this region that owe their development to foreign investment? If so, what local socio-economic benefits have arisen from this investment?” “What impact might foreign control over a resource have on its rate of extraction?” “Why might a government legislate limits on foreign investment? Do any countries in this region have such legislation?”

If so, does it focus on a particular sector of the economy?" "Which stakeholders might encourage the expansion of foreign investment in the region? Which stakeholders might seek reductions in, or greater regulations placed on, such investment? Why?"

D3.6 analyse the role of travel and tourism in the economy of the region as well as the environmental and cultural impact of the tourism industry

Sample questions: "What proportion of the regional economy is related to travel and tourism? Who benefits from the tourism dollars?" "From where do the majority of

tourists originate? How have their cultural expectations affected the region?" "Does this region have environmentally sensitive areas that are an attraction for tourists? If so, do you think the region effectively balances access to and protection of these sites?" "What impact has the tourism industry had on local cultures? Do you think tourism and traditional cultures can co-exist? Is the commercialization of cultures inevitable in a tourist region? Why or why not? Is such commercialization evident in this region? What is gained by such commercialization? What is lost?"

E. DYNAMICS AND CHANGE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Globalization:** analyse how globalization has affected the selected region and how the region has responded to it (**FOCUS ON:** *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*)
- E2. Shifting Populations:** analyse current as well as historical patterns of population movement and distribution in the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*)
- E3. Climate Change and Natural Hazards:** explain how climate, including climate change, and natural hazards affect the selected region (**FOCUS ON:** *Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships*)

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Globalization

FOCUS ON: *Interrelationships; Geographic Perspective*

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** assess the impact of globalization on the people of the region (*e.g., with reference to human rights, types of jobs and working conditions, quality of life, minority and indigenous cultures*)

Sample questions: “How would you measure the short- or long-term impact of globalization in the region?” “Are human rights in the region threatened or improved by globalization?” “How have political and/or social conditions or practices changed as a result of globalization?” “How have working conditions changed as a result of globalization? Are they better or worse than before?” “Has globalization helped or hindered the economic development of the region? What evidence supports your answer?” “What evidence do you see of the globalization of culture in the region?”

Using spatial skills: Students could illustrate data on factors related to globalization – number of MNCs, cultural imports/exports, loss/gain of manufacturing jobs, outsourcing – on a map of the region. Students could annotate the map with their analysis of the impact of globalization in the region.

- E1.2** assess the impact of globalization on the natural environment in the region (*e.g., loss of forest as a result of demand for grazing land, and its impact on regional and global climate; weak environmental regulations as an inducement to industrial development; invasive species; air*

pollution and greenhouse gases from increased industrial production; threats to fresh water supplies as a result of global demands for water; threats to native and heritage vegetation, and animals that depend on them, from genetically modified crops)

Sample questions: “Where would you look for evidence about how globalization is affecting the environment in the region?” “Has environmental legislation in the region changed as a result of globalization?” “Are multinational corporations threatening the sustainability of the natural environment in the region?” “Is there evidence that the impact of globalization on the local/regional environment is contributing to global environmental challenges?” “How would you rate the success of this region in protecting the global commons?”

- E1.3** describe local, national, regional, and/or international policies and strategies that address issues associated with globalization, and assess their effectiveness (*e.g., with reference to anti-globalization movements/protests, movements/support for rights/land claims of indigenous peoples, local food movements and buy-local campaigns, organic farming, the trend in stores and restaurants towards identifying sustainably harvested fish and other seafood*)

Sample questions: “What impact has the increasing flow of goods, people, and services had on human health? What are some strategies that address health issues associated with globalization?” “What are the goals of the antiglobalization movement? How effective do you think this movement has been in achieving its goals? What are some barriers to its success?”

E2. Shifting Populations

FOCUS ON: *Spatial Significance; Patterns and Trends*

By the end of this course, students will:

E2.1 identify migration patterns in this region and analyse their significance (*e.g., whether people tend to immigrate to or emigrate from the region and the sociocultural impact of that trend; the presence and impact of refugees; internal migrations, including urbanization; migration related to work; the impact of migration on population distribution*)

Sample questions: “Is the population flow in this region national, regional, or international?” “What factors have led to population movement in the region? What specific locations have attracted migrants? Why?” “Are there a significant number of refugees in this region? If so, do they tend to be political, economic, or environmental refugees? What circumstances led to their status as refugees? Where are they living? Why are they living there?” “How important are remittances from emigrants to the economic health of people in this region?”

E2.2 explain how population distribution has changed historically in the region as a result of changes in population growth, political power, the economy, and/or technology (*e.g., demographic factors such as changes in birth and infant mortality rates; the impact of epidemics, particularly on indigenous populations; the impact of decolonization; economic changes such as the growth and/or decline of resource towns; rural depopulation as a result of factors such as increasingly large farms or unsustainable agricultural practices; the impact of the car on the growth of suburbia in some regions*)

Sample questions: “What demographic change in the region can be measured over the past hundred years?” “What was the population of this region fifty years ago? What is it now? If there has been an increase, is it due mostly to natural increase or to immigration?” “When you compare maps showing population distribution in the past with that of today, what are the most significant changes? How would you account for them? Do you notice any aspects of the distribution that have not changed over time? If so, why do you think they have remained largely the same?” “Are there areas that have experienced depopulation or that have been abandoned completely? If so, what accounts for this?”

E2.3 analyse the effects of rural-to-urban population shifts on the region

Sample questions: “What stresses has rural-to-urban migration placed on the infrastructure of

cities in the region?” “Has this type of migration resulted in social conflict?” “What are the social and economic effects of a declining rural population in the region?” “Under what circumstances, if any, should a government restrict internal population movement? Is there any evidence of such policies in this region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can analyse graphs showing migration and city population statistics to determine areas of population change. Trends can be plotted on a base map, to which annotations can be added to provide information about the “arrival city” that has received the migrants.

E3. Climate Change and Natural Hazards

FOCUS ON: *Patterns and Trends; Interrelationships*

By the end of this course, students will:

E3.1 explain how various factors affect weather and climate patterns in the region (*e.g., physical features such as mountains, deserts, or bodies of water; ocean currents; latitude; climate change*)

Sample questions: “Are there major water bodies that have an impact on the region’s weather and climate?” “Is there any evidence of climate change in the weather patterns of the region?”

Using spatial skills: Students can construct a story map showing the factors that affect local climate. Symbols could be used to illustrate ocean currents, air masses, mountain ranges, water bodies, and so on, and annotations could be added to explain their effect on weather/climate.

E3.2 explain how climate change currently affects the region and how it is likely to do so in the future

Sample questions: “Have coastal areas in the region experienced increased flooding and/or storm activity?” “What impact would a rise in sea level have on this region and its population?” “Has climate change had an impact on agricultural activity in the region? Do you think it might in the future? Why or why not?” “Has climate change had an impact on human health in the region? Is it likely to do so in the future?”

E3.3 identify natural hazards to which the region is vulnerable (*e.g., volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, tsunamis, drought, landslides, avalanches, floods, tornadoes, hurricanes, typhoons, cyclones*), and assess the level of preparedness in the region for natural and/or human-created disasters

Sample questions: “Is this region particularly vulnerable to a specific natural hazard? What

impact could such a hazard have? In what ways could the impact be minimized by effective preparedness measures?" "What indicators of disaster preparedness are evident in the selected region? Who is responsible for disaster preparedness?" "When you examine a past natural disaster in this region, can you explain how effective the preparedness measures were? Have they been improved since that time?" "Looking at a human-created disaster in the region, do you think it could have been prevented if better safeguards had been in place? Did the disaster lead to any changes in policy/practices?" "What options for financial protection are available to families who live in high-risk areas?"